

Gilded Nail Bar — Brand & Business Guide

Version 2.0 — June 2026

Prepared for the owner. This document covers the brand identity, the website (what's built, how it works, what's planned), and all business-critical details.

00 — Business Overview

0.1 The Vision

Gilded Nail Bar is a luxury nail artistry studio in Uptown Dallas (3636 McKinney Ave) that occupies the intersection of wabi-sabi minimalism and bespoke opulence. The brand rejects the fluorescent-lit, fast-turnover salon model in favor of quiet ritual, botanical ingredients, and hand-placed gold leaf precision.

The website is the digital front door. It must feel like walking into the physical space — warm beige, raw textures, no hard corners, no rush.

0.2 Current Status (v1 — Static Site)

The live website is a **single-page HTML/CSS/JS application** (no backend, no database). All data (services, bookings, reviews, gift cards) is client-side mock data stored in `localStorage`. This is intentional for v1 — it allows the owner to test the complete booking flow, review system, and admin dashboard without needing a server.

Go-live date: Not yet deployed to production domain. Currently on Vercel (preview).

0.3 Business Goals — What This Site Must Do

Goal	Status	Notes
Let guests browse services and prices	✅ Done (v1)	Full service catalog with categories, descriptions, prices
Let guests book appointments online	✅ Done (v1, mock)	4-step flow: Service → Stylist → Date/Time → Contact Info
Let guests see real-time slot availability	🚧 v2	Currently uses localStorage mock data
Send confirmation emails + SMS reminders	🚧 v2	Resend (email) + Twilio (SMS)
Owner admin dashboard	🚧 v2	View bookings, confirm/cancel, block slots, manage services
Live reviews feed	🚧 v2	Currently mock data in localStorage
Gallery with real nail art photography	🚧 v2	Currently "Coming Soon" placeholder
Gift cards — purchase and send	✅ Done (v1, mock)	UI complete, no payment gateway yet
Private events inquiry form	✅ Done (v1)	Data saved to localStorage

SEO / Google Business presence	✅ Partial	Schema.org structured data, OG tags, meta descriptions
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0.4 Target Audience

Segment	Description
Primary	Women 28–55, HHI \$150K+, Uptown / Knox / Turtle Creek Dallas. Professionals, creatives, and socials who value design, craft, and discretion.
Secondary	Men seeking precision dry manicures. Bridal parties for private events. Brand collaborators (fashion editorials, trunk shows).
Psychographic	Values quality over quantity. Seeks experiences over transactions. Reads Kinfolk, Cereal, Monocle.

01 — Website Feature Inventory (v1)

Every interactive feature on the site, explained for the owner.

1.1 Splash Screen

When a guest first visits the site, they see a full-screen entrance with an animated logo reveal:

- 1. **Concrete circle** blooms outward (0.05s after page load)
- 2. **Diamond** pops in (0.2s) — the center of the logo mark
- 3. **Monoline bars** draw outward from the diamond (0.55s / 0.7s)
- 4. **"Gilded"** slides down into place (1.1s) — gold foil shimmer begins
- 5. **"Nail Bar"** slides up into place (1.35s)
- 6. **Divider line** draws across (1.55s)
- 7. **"3636 McKinney Ave, Uptown Dallas"** types out character by character (1.8s)
- 8. Guest clicks **"ENTER SALON"** to proceed

The splash only appears once per session (controlled by `sessionStorage`). Returning visitors skip directly to the page content.

The diamond is clickable/tappable — tapping it triggers a sparkle burst animation.

1.2 Header & Navigation

- **Logo** (left): Inline text mark — "Gilded" in Cormorant Garamond, monoline–diamond–monoline separator, "Nail Bar" in IBM Plex Mono. Hovering the logo makes the diamond rotate 135° and the bars extend wider. The diamond also subtly follows the cursor (magnetic effect, ±5px).
- **"Menu" button** (right): Opens a full-screen mega menu with navigation links and a brand image panel.
- **"Book Appointment" button** (right): Sticky CTA that scrolls to the booking section.
- **Mobile**: Hamburger icon replaces the menu button on small screens.

1.3 Category Heroes (The Scroll Column)

Four full-viewport sections, one per service category:

- **MANICURES** (Structured Gel, Signature Gilded, etc.)
- **PEDICURES** (Stone Soak, Gilded Organic, etc.)
- **ENHANCEMENTS** (Aprés Gel-X, Hard Gel, etc.)

- **FINISHES & DETAILS** (Gold Foil Accent, Nail Art, etc.)

Each hero has a category number (01–04), a diamond accent, and an "Explore" button that scrolls to the service menu.

1.4 Services Menu (THE APOTHECARY → TREATMENTS & RITUALS)

- **Filter tabs:** ALL / MANICURES / PEDICURES / ENHANCEMENTS / FINISHES
- **Service cards:** Show name, description, price, and duration. Cards animate in on scroll with staggered fade-up.
- **Category headers:** "THE APOTHECARY" (section subtitle), "TREATMENTS & RITUALS" (section heading).
- **Prices are real** — do not change without owner approval.

1.5 Booking Wizard (4 Steps)

The booking flow is the most complex feature on the site:

Step	Panel	What the guest does
1	Service	Selects a treatment from the catalog
2	Stylist	Selects a nail artist
3	Date & Time	Picks a date (Tue–Sat only) and an available 1-hour time slot (10AM–6PM)
4	Confirm	Enters name, email, phone, agrees to deposit policy, sees receipt

Business rules enforced:

- Only Tuesday–Saturday dates are selectable (Sunday/Monday disabled)
- Time slots are 1-hour: 10:00, 11:00, 12:00, 1:00, 2:00, 3:00, 4:00, 5:00, 6:00 (9 slots per day per technician)
- Slots already booked are shown with a "Join waitlist" option
- Slots that have already passed today are disabled
- Guest can book up to 60 days in advance
- After confirming, a receipt modal shows with an ICS calendar download button

Current limitation (v1): All booking data is stored in `localStorage` under the key `gilded_booked_slots`. This means bookings are not synced between devices or persisted. This is the #1 feature to migrate to a real database in v2.

1.6 Reviews Section

- Guests can read existing reviews (mock data in v1) with star ratings (1–5)
- Guests can submit new reviews via a form (saved to `localStorage`)
- Reviews display: customer name, rating (visual stars using inline SVG), review text
- "Write a Review" toggle button shows/hides the submission form

1.7 FAQ Accordion

Six expandable questions about services, pricing, appointment policies, walk-ins, nail health, and gift cards. Clicking a question slides open the answer with a smooth `max-height` transition. The chevron arrow rotates 180° when open.

1.8 Loyalty Program ("Your Stamp Card")

A visual stamp card with 10 circles. Each click fills a stamp with a pop animation (scale bounce). When all 10 are filled, a "Claim Reward" button appears. A two-click confirmation system prevents accidental resets ("RESET CARD" → "CONFIRM RESET?" with 4s timeout).

Current limitation (v1): Stamps are stored in localStorage. In v2, this would be tied to a customer account.

1.9 Gallery (THE VAULT)

A filtered grid with tabs (ALL / MANICURES / PEDICURES / ENHANCEMENTS). Currently shows a "COMING SOON" overlay on each card — this is where real nail art photography will go in v2. Hovering a card reveals the overlay text.

1.10 Botanical Cabinet

A dark-themed section (bronze background, cream text) showcasing botanical ingredients used in treatments: Sea Salt Soak, French Green Clay, Manuka Honey, Argan Oil, Coconut Milk, Oat Milk. Each card has a Roman numeral (I–VI), ingredient name, and description. Cards stagger in on scroll with a 0.4s cascade delay between each.

1.11 Try-On Color Preview

A small interactive feature where tapping a polish color swatch shows a preview rectangle (80×80px) in that color. Does not use the camera — it's a simple visual reference for the guest.

1.12 Gift Cards

- Three preset amounts: \$50, \$100, \$200 (with \$75, \$150, \$250 also available via button toggle)
- Guest enters recipient email and optional message
- Confirmation modal shows before processing
- **Current limitation (v1):** No payment gateway — purchases are simulated in localStorage

1.13 Private Events Inquiry

A modal form for guests interested in private parties (bridal, birthday, corporate). Collects: name, email, phone, guest count, event type, preferred date, and notes. On submission, data is saved to localStorage (`gilded_private_events`). A success message displays, then the modal closes after 3 seconds.

1.14 Rebook Nudge

After 7 days, if a previous booking reminder exists in localStorage, a floating card appears in the bottom-right corner inviting the guest to rebook. The card has a close button and a "Book Again" link.

1.15 Footer (THE STUDIO)

Contains:

- Location: 3636 McKinney Ave, Suite 150, Dallas, TX 75204 (with Google Maps link)
- Contact: (214) 555-0145, info@gildednailbar.com
- Hours: Tue–Sat 10AM–7PM
- Accordion panels: "Visit Us", "Hours & Information", "Connect"
- Inline logo mark
- Copyright notice

02 — Website Roadmap (v2 — Full-Stack Migration)

2.1 Why Migrate

The current v1 site is static. To offer real-time booking, email/SMS notifications, an owner dashboard, and persistent data, the site needs a backend. The target stack is:

Layer	Technology
Framework	Next.js (App Router) — hosted on Vercel
Database	PostgreSQL (Vercel Postgres or Neon)
ORM	Drizzle ORM
Auth	Auth.js (NextAuth v5) — owner login only
Email	Resend — confirmation + notification emails
SMS	Twilio — appointment reminders
Payments	(Stripe — for gift cards, future)
Images	/public folder — no external CDN
Styling	CSS Modules + global CSS variables (no Tailwind)

2.2 Phase 1 — Real Integrations (Next Priority)

Feature	What changes
PostgreSQL booking system	Replace all localStorage booking data with a real database. Slots are queried from appointments and blocked_slots tables.
Auth.js admin login	Owner can log in with email/password to access a dashboard. Single owner role.
Owner dashboard	View all upcoming/past bookings, confirm or cancel appointments, block time slots (vacations/closures), manage services (add/edit/archive), manage technicians (add/edit/availability).
Email notifications	On booking: confirmation email to guest + notification email to owner. On cancellation: cancellation email. Via Resend.
SMS reminders	24-hour-before appointment reminder via Twilio.
Live reviews feed	Reviews stored in database, owner approves before publishing, guest sees approved reviews only.
Contact form	Inquiries (from the "Contact" section) sent via Resend to owner email.

2.3 Phase 2 — Content & Pages

Feature	Description
Gallery	Replace "Coming Soon" overlays with real photography. Image optimization via Next.js <Image> component.
Team bios	Profiles for each nail artist with photo, specialty, and bio.
Gift cards (real)	Purchase gift cards via Stripe. Send email to recipient with a unique code.

Loyalty program (real)	Track stamps in database. Automatic reward after 10 visits.
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2.4 Phase 3 — Performance & SEO

- Lighthouse score 95+ on all metrics
- Schema.org structured data (already partially implemented)
- Google Business Profile integration
- Next.js Image optimization for all photography
- Structured data for services, reviews, and FAQs

2.5 Phase 4 — Multi-Location (Future)

- Additional Texas locations with location-specific routing
- Location selector on the splash screen
- Per-location services, technicians, and availability

03 — Brand Foundation

3.1 Brand Essence

Gilded Nail Bar is a sanctuary of raw luxury — where the unadorned meets the precious. We sit at the intersection of wabi-sabi minimalism and bespoke opulence, offering nail artistry that honors natural form while indulging in rare materials and masterful technique.

3.2 Brand Pillars

Pillar	Description
Raw Luxury	Luxury stripped of pretension. Natural materials, honest textures, quiet opulence.
Apothecary Craft	Treatments rooted in botanical ingredients, formulated with the precision of an old-world apothecary.
Artisan Precision	Every service is a bespoke creation. Russian dry technique, hand-placed gold leaf, sculptural gel work.
Sacred Ritual	The appointment is a ritual, not a transaction. Stillness, attention, sensory care.

3.3 Brand Persona

If Gilded Nail Bar were a person:

- **Archetype:** The Alchemist / The Curator
- **Character:** Quietly confident, discerning, warm but reserved. Speaks in carefully chosen words. Dressed in raw silk and aged leather. Collects Japanese ceramics and rare botanical extracts.
- **Aspirational References:** Le Labo (apothecary minimalism), C.O. Bigelow (heritage apothecary), Aesop (sensory formulations), Rick Owens (raw architectural forms), Axel Vervoordt (wabi-sabi interiors).

3.4 Mission Statement

To provide a sanctuary for hands and mind through precision nail artistry, botanical care, and an environment that honors stillness, material honesty, and the beauty of imperfection.

04 — Logo & Wordmark

4.1 Primary Logo (Current — Inline Text Mark)

The Gilded Nail Bar logo is an **inline text mark** built in HTML/CSS (no image file). It has three parts:

Gilded	← Cormorant Garamond, italic, gold (#c4a67a) on splash
— ◆ —	← Monoline bar / diamond / monoline bar (1px lines, 6×6px diamond rotated 45°)
NAIL BAR	← IBM Plex Mono, uppercase, bronze (#584638)

4.2 Logo Variations

Variation	Use Case
Splash logo (full)	Splash entrance screen — "Gilded" in gold with foil shimmer animation
Header logo	Fixed navigation bar — compact, bronze, smaller text
Footer logo	Footer — same as header, centered in the footer layout
Gift card logo	Inside the gift card purchase modal — same structure

4.3 Logo Animation Rules

- Splash entrance:** Diamond appears first (scale 0→1), then bars draw outward, then "Gilded" slides in, then "Nail Bar" slides in. Total duration ~1.35s.
- After reveal:** Diamond pulses gently (breathing light effect, 3s cycle). "Gilded" has a continuous gold foil shimmer (gradient sweep, 5s cycle).
- Header hover:** Diamond rotates 135°, bars extend from 16px→24px width. Magnetic cursor effect: diamond follows mouse ±5px.
- Click/tap:** Clicking the splash diamond triggers a sparkle burst (scale to 1.6× + gold glow).

4.4 Logo Misuse

Never:

- Use the old PNG logo (`gilded_logo.png`) in the UI — it exists only for OG/schema.org meta tags
- Change the font or font weight of the text mark
- Change the diamond rotation angle (always 45°)
- Remove or replace the monoline bars
- Place the logo on a low-contrast background
- Use a different brand mark or icon

05 — Color Palette

5.1 Primary Palette

Token	Hex	RGB	Use
--bg-brand	#f8efe1	248, 239, 225	Page background — cream silk

--color-text	#584638	88, 70, 56	Primary text, headers, borders — earthy bronze
--color-gold	#c4a67a	196, 166, 122	Accent — splash logo "Gilded", hero diamonds, button hover lines

5.2 Secondary Palette

Token	Hex	RGB	Use
--bg-secondary	#f2ebe0	242, 235, 224	Card shading, panel backgrounds, splash concrete circle
--bg-concrete	#eae3d7	234, 227, 215	Footer, dividers, raw stone zones
--color-muted	#8a7c71	138, 124, 113	Labels, descriptions, secondary text
--border-color	rgba(88, 70, 56, 0.25)	—	Subtle borders, dividers, disabled states

5.3 Accent Palette (Editorial Use Only)

Name	Hex	Use
Gold Foil	#c4a67a	Accents, highlights (same as --color-gold)
Deep Espresso	#3d3229	Extreme depth — dark section text, overlays

5.4 Color Rules

- **Never** introduce colors outside this palette
- **Never** use pure black (#000000) — use Deep Espresso or Bronze
- **Always** maintain 4.5:1 minimum contrast for body text (WCAG AA)
- The brand lives in warmth — avoid cool grays, blues, or stark whites
- Dark sections (botanical cabinet) use bronze background, cream text, gold card names

06 — Typography

6.1 Typeface Family

Typeface	Weight Range	Usage
Cormorant Garamond	Light 300, Regular 400, Medium 500, Semibold 600, Italic variants	Headings, display, pull quotes — the brand voice
IBM Plex Mono	Light 300, Regular 400, Medium 500, Semibold 600	UI labels, prices, metadata, step indicators, all-caps accents
Inter	Light 300, Regular 400, Medium 500, Semibold 600	Body copy, descriptions, form inputs, navigation

All fonts loaded via Google Fonts with `display=swap` .

6.2 Type Hierarchy

Level 1 – Hero Display
Cormorant Garamond, Italic, 2.8rem / 3.2rem
Letter-spacing: -0.01em, Weight: 500
Level 2 – Section Title
Cormorant Garamond, Italic, 2.5rem / 2.8rem
Letter-spacing: -0.01em, Weight: 500
Level 3 – Card / Component Title
Cormorant Garamond, Italic, 1.4rem / 1.6rem
Weight: 500
Level 4 – Subtitle / Meta
IBM Plex Mono, Uppercase, 0.75rem / 1rem
Letter-spacing: 0.2em, Weight: 400
Level 5 – Body Copy
Inter, 0.95rem / 1.6, Weight: 400
Level 6 – Labels / Captions
IBM Plex Mono, Uppercase, 0.65rem / 0.9rem
Letter-spacing: 0.1em, Weight: 400
Level 7 – Pricing / Data
IBM Plex Mono, 0.95rem / 1.2, Weight: 500

6.3 Type Rules

- No typefaces outside the specified three
- All-caps only with IBM Plex Mono — never with Cormorant or Inter
- Line length: 55–75 characters per line for body text
- Italic is reserved for Cormorant Garamond headings and pull quotes only
- Never use faux-bold, faux-italic, or synthetic typeface styling

6.4 Section Headers (Finalized — Do Not Change)

Section	Subtitle (Mono)	Heading (Cormorant Italic)
Services	THE APOTHECARY	Treatments & Rituals
Gallery	—	The Vault
FAQ	—	Guidance & Etiquette
Location/Contact	—	The Studio
Botanical	—	(Section has dark background, no heading style)

07 — Voice & Tone

7.1 Brand Voice Principles

Principle	Description
Sparse	Fewer words, greater impact. Every word earns its place.
Sensory	Describe textures, temperatures, light, and materials. Evoke the physical.
Precise	"Hand-placed 24k liquid gold foil leaf" not "gold stickers." Technical accuracy is part of the luxury.
Warm	Never cold or corporate. The warmth of the cream silk background carries into the copy.
Ritualistic	Language of ceremony and care. The appointment is a ritual, the hands are honored.

7.2 Do & Don't

Do Say	Don't Say
"A sanctuary for your hands"	"A nail salon"
"Hand-placed 24k liquid gold foil leaf accents"	"Gold nail stickers"
"Russian dry cuticle precision care"	"Cuticle trimming"
"Bespoke structured gel overlay"	"Gel nails"
"Botanical Cabinet"	"Products page"
"Guest"	"Customer"
"Reservation"	"Booking" (except in UI context)
"Master Artist"	"Nail tech"

7.3 Tone Matrix

Context	Tone	Example
Service description	Poetic, precise	"Dry cuticle precision care, structured base reinforcement, and hand-placed 24k liquid gold foil leaf accents."
Booking flow	Clear, warm	"Select the treatment you would like to reserve."
Error / validation	Direct, polite	"Please select a service before proceeding."
Confirmation	Celebratory, ritual	"Your reservation is confirmed. Thank you for choosing Gilded Nail Bar."
Social media	Intimate, editorial	"Saturday light on McKinney Ave. Gold foil, quiet hands."
FAQ	Helpful, thorough	"Our structured gel manicures typically last 2–3 weeks with proper aftercare."

08 — Photography & Imagery

8.1 Image Direction

The Gilded visual language is raw, textured, and intimate. Images should feel editorial, not commercial.

Subjects:

- Close-cropped hands in natural poses — never splayed or artificial
- Hands interacting with raw materials: stone, ceramic, linen, gold leaf
- Salon interiors: concrete surfaces, natural light, linen curtains, aged brass
- Botanical ingredients in their raw state: honey, milk, salt, clay, argan oil
- Negative space — let the frame breathe

Lighting:

- Natural daylight only — no harsh studio strobes or ring lights
- Golden hour warmth, soft window light, directional north light
- High contrast but underexposed shadows — moody but not dark

Post-Processing:

- Desaturated slightly from natural (warm shift, not cool)
- Sepia tone lift in shadows (+8–12%)
- Reduced clarity / texture for skin (soft, not blurred)
- Film grain simulation (very subtle)

8.2 What Never to Photograph

- Fluorescent-lit salon shots
- Overhead group hands (the "Instagram nail spread")
- Hands holding phones, coffee cups, or props
- Busy backgrounds, patterned fabrics, or reflective surfaces
- Overly manicured models — real hands, real skin

8.3 Color Treatment

All imagery should carry the brand's warm beige undertone:

- White balance shifted +300K toward warmth
- Shadows tinted toward bronze `#584638`
- Highlights tinted toward cream `#f8efe1`
- Black point lifted slightly (no pure blacks in shadows)

09 — Iconography

9.1 Icon Style

- **Line weight:** 1.5px consistent stroke
- **Corners:** Rounded (stroke-linejoin: round, stroke-linecap: round)
- **Size:** 1em base, scaled proportionally
- **Color:** CurrentColor (inherits from text), always mono
- **Style:** Minimal, geometric, no filled areas
- **Animation:** Hover pulse or rotation on interactive icons

9.2 Icon System

The brand uses a **custom SVG sprite system** — all icons are defined as `<symbol>` elements in an inline `<svg>` block in `index.html` . There is no FontAwesome dependency. At page load, JavaScript replaces every `<i class="fa-...">` element with the corresponding inline SVG from the sprite.

If you add new icons: Define a new `<symbol id="icon-name">` in the SVG sprite block and add a mapping in the `faMap` object in `app.js` .

9.3 Icon Usage Rules

- Never use emoji as icons
- Never use third-party icon libraries (FontAwesome, Material Icons, Phosphor)
- Never color icons outside the brand palette
- All interactive icons must have `aria-hidden="true"` on the SVG and `aria-label` on the parent button

10 — Patterns, Textures & Materials

10.1 Physical Materials (Salon Space)

Material	Application
Raw concrete	Walls, counters, flooring
Linen	Curtains, towels, appointment cards
Aged brass	Fixtures, signage, tools
Matte ceramic	Product vessels, soak bowls
Uncoated paper	Business cards, menus, gift cards
Warm wood	Reception, shelving, furniture

10.2 Digital Textures

- **Linen grain:** A subtle SVG noise filter overlay (`body::after`) at 0.025 opacity with `mix-blend-mode: multiply` — mimics the feel of raw linen fabric across the entire page
- **Border treatment:** Thin solid strokes (1px) — never border-radius on anything
- **Shadows:** Warm-toned using `rgba(88, 70, 56, 0.12)` — never cool gray shadows
- **Divider lines:** 80px wide, 1px high, bronze color

11 — Booking System (Detailed)

The most complex feature on the site. This section explains exactly how it works so the owner understands the flow and limitations.

11.1 Business Hours

Day	Status	Hours
Sunday	Closed	—

Monday	Closed	—
Tuesday	Open	10:00 AM – 7:00 PM
Wednesday	Open	10:00 AM – 7:00 PM
Thursday	Open	10:00 AM – 7:00 PM
Friday	Open	10:00 AM – 7:00 PM
Saturday	Open	10:00 AM – 7:00 PM

11.2 Slot Logic

- Appointments are **1-hour slots**
- 9 slots per day per technician: 10:00, 11:00, 12:00, 1:00, 2:00, 3:00, 4:00, 5:00, 6:00
- A slot is available if: the day is Tue–Sat, the slot is not already booked, it is not in blocked slots, and (if today) it has not already passed
- Guests can book up to 60 days in advance
- Sunday and Monday dates are grayed out and unselectable in the calendar

11.3 The 4-Step Flow

Step 1 — Service: Guest selects a treatment from the catalog. Services are organized by category. Selecting one highlights it with a bronze fill.

Step 2 — Stylist: Guest selects a preferred nail artist. Currently shows mock data (Elena, Marcus, Simone, Yuki).

Step 3 — Date & Time: Guest picks a date from a custom calendar (Tue–Sat only, 60-day lookahead). After selecting a date, available 1-hour time slots appear. Booked slots show a "Join waitlist" button. Past slots (for today) are grayed out.

Step 4 — Contact Info: Guest enters name, email, and phone number. Must agree to the deposit policy checkbox. "Confirm Appointment" button shows a receipt modal.

11.4 Receipt & Calendar Export

After confirming, a receipt modal shows:

- Service name, stylist name, date, time, total price
- "Add to Calendar" button downloads an ICS file (valid RFC 5545 format)
- A preparation checklist (arrive 5 min early, avoid cuticle oil, etc.)
- A receipt badge pulse animation

11.5 What v1 Does NOT Do (Waiting for v2)

- ❌ Real-time sync between devices
- ❌ Email confirmation to guest
- ❌ Email notification to owner
- ❌ SMS reminder 24h before
- ❌ Owner dashboard to view/manage bookings
- ❌ Block time slots (vacations, closures)
- ❌ Manage services or technicians

12 — Owner Dashboard (v2)

This will be built in Phase 1 of the v2 migration. The dashboard will be a password-protected page (Auth.js, single owner role) that lets the owner:

Feature	Description
View bookings	List of all upcoming and past appointments with guest contact info
Confirm / Cancel	Mark a booking as confirmed, or cancel with automatic notification
Block slots	Block specific date/time slots for vacations, closures, or personal time
Manage services	Add new services, edit prices/descriptions, archive retired ones
Manage technicians	Add/edit nail artists, set their availability
View private events inquiries	See all submitted private events form data
View gift card purchases	See all gift card transactions

13 — Services & Pricing (Finalized)

These are the real services and prices. **Do not change without owner approval.**

Category	Service	Price	Duration
Manicures	Signature Gilded Manicure	\$120	60 min
Manicures	Structured Gel Manicure	\$85	45 min
Manicures	The Restoration Manicure	\$95	50 min
Manicures	Classic Organic Manicure	\$65	30 min
Pedicures	Stone Soak Pedicure	\$95	50 min
Pedicures	Gilded Organic Pedicure	\$125	60 min
Pedicures	The Recovery Pedicure	\$105	55 min
Pedicures	Classic Organic Pedicure	\$75	35 min
Enhancements	Après Gel-X Extensions	\$115	75 min
Enhancements	Hard Gel Overlay	\$100	60 min
Enhancements	Gel-X Removal + New Set	\$145	90 min
Finishes	Gold Foil Accent (per nail)	\$12	—
Finishes	Custom Nail Art (per nail)	\$18	—
Finishes	French Fade or Ombre	\$15	—

14 — Social Media

14.1 Grid Aesthetic

- **Palette:** 80% cream/beige tones, 15% bronze text, 5% editorial color
- **Texture:** Slight film grain, warm desaturated tones
- **Layout:** Alternating product shots, detail macros, and text-on-cream cards
- **No:** Bright filters, hard shadows, busy compositions, hashtag-heavy captions

14.2 Instagram Feed Strategy

Content Type	Frequency	Description
Nail Art Detail	40%	Macro close-ups of gold foil, chrome, linework
Atmosphere	25%	Salon interior, natural light, material details
Educational	15%	Technique spotlights (Russian manicure, Gel-X process)
Text Cards	10%	Typographic quotes, service announcements on cream background
Client / Editorial	10%	Reposted client tags, editorial collaborations

14.3 Profile

- **Avatar:** Logo mark on cream (square crop) — the inline text mark rendered as a square image
- **Bio format:** "3636 McKinney Ave, Uptown Dallas _ Bespoke nail artistry _ Tue–Sat 10–7 _ Book via link"
- **Link:** Direct to booking page (v2), or link-in-bio tool (v1)

15 — Print & Physical Applications

Item	Specs
Business Cards	400gsm uncoated cotton fiber, 85×55mm, letterpress bronze ink, blind emboss logo on reverse, IBM Plex Mono 7pt
Gift Cards	600gsm matte board with bronze foil edge, cream stock, Cormorant Garamond logo, linen envelope with bronze wax seal
Appointment Cards	300gsm uncoated cream, 120×50mm, handwritten slot for date/time
Private Menu / Lookbook	Saddle-stitched booklet, 210×270mm, 350gsm cover with bronze foil, 120gsm interior

16 — Technical Notes

16.1 File Structure (Current)

File	Purpose
index.html	Single-page site markup (all sections, SVG sprite, structured data)
styles.css	Complete style system (~4200 lines) — design tokens, logo mark CSS, all animations, responsive

app.js	All JavaScript (~1800 lines) — splash entrance, booking wizard, navigation, reviews, gallery, FAQ, etc.
BRAND_GUIDELINES.md	This document
gilded_logo.png	Legacy PNG logo — kept for OG/schema.org meta tags only, not displayed in UI
project_constitution.md	Design + architecture standards reference
task_plan.md	Phase tracking (BLAST framework)
CLAUDE.md	AI assistant instructions

16.2 No External Dependencies

The current site has zero runtime dependencies:

- No CSS frameworks (no Tailwind, no Bootstrap)
- No JavaScript libraries (no jQuery, no React, no Alpine)
- No icon libraries (FontAwesome icons are replaced with inline SVGs at runtime)
- No CDN-hosted assets
- All fonts loaded from Google Fonts with standard `<link>` tags

16.3 Browser Support

- Modern browsers: Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge (latest 2 versions)
- The site uses `background-clip: text` for the gold foil shimmer — supported in all modern browsers
- The site respects `prefers-reduced-motion` — all animations are disabled for users with that setting

17 — Key Contacts

Role	Contact
Salon Address	3636 McKinney Ave, Suite 150, Dallas, TX 75204
Phone	(214) 555-0145
Email	info@gildednailbar.com
Website	https://www.gildednailbar.com (not yet live)

18 — Quick Reference (Do's & Don'ts)

Context	Do	Don't
Logo	Use the inline text mark	Use the old PNG logo or any other image
Colors	Stay within brand palette	Introduce cool tones, pure black, or bright colors
Typography	Use three approved typefaces	Use system fonts, decorative, or variable fonts
Imagery	Shoot warm, raw, editorial	Use stock photos or flash photography
Voice	Write sparse, sensory, precise	Write corporate, wordy, or generic

UI	Thin borders, no radius, mono labels	Round corners, shadows, or gradients
Social	Warm desaturated grid, text cards	Bright filters, emoji-heavy, hashtag spam
Services	Use real names and real prices	Replace with placeholder copy
Booking	Understand it's mock data in v1	Assume bookings are real/synced

Gilded Nail Bar — Brand & Business Guide v2.0 For inquiries: info@gildednailbar.com